

Philipp Hilbert. *Product owner who ships, not just manages.*

Positioning, 13 years of end-to-end product ownership in regulated industries, insurance, healthcare, payments, now applied to a single-product build mandate in Dubai.

BERLIN, GERMANY · [HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](mailto:hilbert@true-north.berlin) · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://true-north.berlin)

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

§ WHY DISCOVERED MENA

This is not a coordination role with a committee behind every decision, it is one product, owned properly, from first idea through to live release. The description calls out depth over breadth explicitly, and that mirrors how I have always worked: the Claims Center at EMIL Group went from concept to production with no internal precedent, compressing time-to-market for a new insurance product from many months to under a week. The posting also names a clear growth path from delivery into strategic product work, which is how a product function ought to be structured. *That combination of genuine ownership today and strategic scope tomorrow is exactly the environment where my strengths compound.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec and edge-case generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, assisted prototyping
- **Cursor**, LLM-assisted development environment
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **GPT**, requirements drafting and stakeholder communication
- **Gamma.app**, structured presentation of product briefs
- **Jira + Confluence**, backlog and sprint management
- **Miro / Figma**, discovery workshops and wireframes

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin with Spring Boot, Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, ETL pipelines, Shopware, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A two-sided B2B staffing marketplace for the construction industry, built to zero by one person.

- Matches construction firms with workers, removing the headhunter from the hire via an anonymity-until-payment model.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface; LLM agents across the funnel so a single operator runs the day-to-day.
 - Built end-to-end alone: discovery, specification, delivery, and operations.
 - Demonstrates the product founder instinct this role calls for, concept to live product, no committee.
-

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT DISCOVERED MENA

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the existing delivery managers, read every handover artefact, and sit with the engineering team to understand the product's current state, open dependencies, and where the backlog is under-specified before touching a single story.

WEEK 2

Slice and sharpen.

Run a backlog audit, rewrite the top 20% of stories to acceptance-criteria standard, and align with stakeholders on the delivery sequence so the first sprint has no ambiguity at stand-up.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Lead sprint ceremonies end to end, instrument the first release metrics, and begin feeding findings back into the roadmap, building the cadence the posting describes as growing into wider strategic product work.

I COVER LETTER

I am writing about the Senior Product Owner role at Discovered MENA. I have spent 13 years owning products end to end in regulated industries, insurance, healthcare, payments, and defence AI, and the shape of this role maps closely to how I actually work: one product, one owner, full responsibility from first idea to live release.

The insurance domain is not adjacent knowledge for me; it is direct experience. At EMIL Group I joined an 18-person delivery organisation that was losing its senior engineers and its client trust simultaneously. I restructured it into three lean teams with their own leads, and then shipped the Claims Center from concept to production with no internal precedent, reducing time-to-market for a new insurance product from many months to under a week. Before that, I spent more than a year as Proxy Product Owner at AOK ITSCare, migrating a procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurance entities and around 20,000 employees, a system still in production today. I understand how insurers buy technology, how compliance shapes the backlog, and why stakeholder alignment in that sector takes longer and matters more than in consumer software.

On the delivery side, I run Agile without making it a ceremony production. At Rohde & Schwarz I introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD across a multinational team: rollout time fell from days to 30 minutes and the platform became hotfix-capable. At Bundesagentur für Arbeit I integrated test automation into the Jenkins pipeline and carried a full UI relaunch through a parallel containerisation programme, while also serving as Deputy IT Security Officer. These are not things I delegated; I owned the technical depth and the stakeholder communication at the same time.

On AI, my engagement is hands-on rather than theoretical. I prototype with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, and Cursor, use LLM agents to generate acceptance criteria and edge-case catalogues, and have built agentic workflows including a multi-agent coding framework I developed independently. I understand where AI speeds up product delivery and where it introduces governance risk, relevant in any financial services environment operating under evolving regulatory expectations.

Dubai is not a compromise location for me. I am actively targeting the UAE and am ready to relocate and work fully on-site or hybrid from day one.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager and product owner with 13 years of end-to-end ownership in regulated industries including insurance, healthcare, payments and defence AI. I turn strategy, user needs and technical constraints into a prioritised backlog and lead cross-functional agile teams through delivery, from first story to production release. Direct insurance domain experience at EMIL Group and AOK ITSCare, combined with a track record of restructuring struggling delivery organisations and shipping products with no internal precedent.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, stand-up, review, retrospective, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, agile release train, PI planning.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, go-to-market support.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act, Explainable AI; prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Technical Environments: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

Governance and Business: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership and financial planning.

Stakeholder and Leadership: stakeholder management, cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE / AI DATA PLATFORM 2024 TO 2025

Introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD across a multinational team, cutting rollout time from days to 30 minutes and making the platform hotfix-capable. Redirected the product from a UI-led design to developer-code-first after instrumenting two competing workflows and finding the UI recorded zero usage.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023 TO 2024

Integrated test automation into Jenkins, introduced Dagster and dbt for quarterly data imports, migrated bare-metal to containers, and carried a full UI relaunch through the same period. Served as Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Cut the backlog to the top 10% of features: user acceptance rose more than fivefold. Implemented the CGM interface into hospital KIS workflows myself, reducing digital anamnesis time from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure. Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production with no precedent, cutting time-to-market for a new insurance product from many months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL PAYMENTS / POS 2021 TO 2022

Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · INTERIM PRODUCT OWNER · SECURE GOVERNMENT DATA 2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PROXY PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH INSURANCE E- COMMERCE 2019 TO 2020

Migrated a legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and around 20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · SITE IT MODERNISATION 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end at wind energy generation facilities.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL NETWORK 2017 TO 2018

WLAN rollout across nine hospitals in a clinical network.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025 TO 2026

Zero to one alone: two-sided B2B marketplace, anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE ENCRYPTION 2016 TO 2021

Shipped a three-layer hardware-software product that installs in under two minutes. Later served as Chair of the board.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P PAYMENTS 2013 TO 2018

Built from zero and taken to acquisition; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · DISCOVERED MENA

→